

June 18, 2026

Mark Ussery, Principal
Porter Ranch School (LAUSD)
12450 Mason Ave, Porter Ranch, CA 91326
msu3964@lausd.net
(818) 709-7100

Dear Principal Ussery,

I am applying for the computer science teacher position at Porter Ranch School for the 2026-2027 school year. Teaching has been a throughline of my life going as far back as high school, and I am eager to culminate its integration into my professional career.

My teaching journey began in high school as a black belt karate instructor for students spanning ages from 6 to 60. That breadth of maturity and mental development provided early insight into the distinct roles of knowledge transmission vs. structure/motivation in education. This sensitivity carried into college where I tutored friends and taught formally as a TA, and through to my 20 years as a software engineer - often presenting to colleagues on new technologies and workflows. These strands of education coalesced while living in Korea, where I worked at an edtech Hagwon as a project manager publishing multimedia ESL textbooks and founded a Toastmasters club, developing a novel education program for ESL speakers to overcome their hesitancy to speak. Finally, over the past 5 years I brought these disparate strands together into a coherent whole when I founded a karate dojo where I have been developing from the ground up an off-the-mat curriculum relating karate to such diverse disciplines as etymology, geometry, pedagogy, and chess. For example, I relate the circular and linear trajectory of kicks to Euclid's treatment of lines and circles as fundamental objects of geometry, and show that a kick angled 30 degrees above horizontal rises half a leg-length above belt height - without mentioning the words sine or hypotenuse.

I am excited for the opportunity to further discuss how I can adapt my experience and skills to meet the demands of the classroom in order to best serve the needs of the students and the broader community.

Sincerely,

David Chung
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